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11th EFSPI Regulatory Statistics Workshop

19 – 20 August 2026

Basel Switzerland

Day 0: 18th August 2026, 19:00-22:00

19:00 – 22:00	**Pre-Conference Regulatory Dinner** *All regulators and HTA assessors* are cordially invited to this (self-paid) event, organized by Benjamin Hofner (PEI, DE) and Heidi Mestl (SAWP member, NoMA, NO). For more information and registration please visit https://forms.gle/ihANxp8V3gUctCMu6

Day 1: 19th August 2026, 08:30-17:30 (+1:30h get-together)

Time	Presentation
08:40 – 09:00 (5 + 15 min)	Housekeeping + **Opening Remarks** Anna Wiksten (EFSPI President, BMS, CH)
09:00 – 10:00 (60 min)	**Short Topics 'reversed'.** **Regulators Question, Industry Answers: An Interactive Panel Session** A committee-selected set of pre-submitted questions is briefly introduced by regulators and then explored in a moderated panel discussion, where industry experts share their experience-based perspectives and practical insights in response. Note: Regulators are invited to submit a problem or question by **19 June 2026**. The Scientific Committee will review all submissions and select up to three topics. If selected, a regulator will be asked to introduce the topic in-person using *no more than three slides* in a *up to five-minute presentation*. A panel of industry experts will then discuss the question and share their insights. Proposals should be sent to Vivian Lanius, Vivian.lanius@ucb.com *Chairs:* *Lukas Aguirre Dávila (SAWP member, PEI, DE), Julie Jones (Novartis, CH)* Panelists: NN (affiliation, country code), NN (affiliation, country code), NN (affiliation, country code), NN (affiliation, country code), NN (affiliation, country code), … Topic 1: NN (affiliation, country code): Title Topic 2: NN (affiliation, country code): Title Topic 3: NN (affiliation, country code): Title
10:00 – 10:30 (30 min)	Coffee break

Day 1: 19th August 2026, 08:30-17:30 (+1:30h get-together) *<continued>*

Time	Presentation
10:30 – 12:30 (120 min)	**Short Topics.** **Engaging Regulators: Industry Questions and Regulatory Insight** A committee-selected set of pre-submitted industry questions is briefly introduced and then discussed by a panel of regulators, who share interpretations based on existing guidance and current regulatory thinking. Note: Please submit a problem or question by **19 June 2026**. The Scientific Committee will review all submissions and select up to six topics. If selected, you will be asked to introduce your topic in-person using *no more than three slides* in a *up to five-minute presentation*. A panel of highly esteemed regulators will then discuss the question and share their insights with you and the audience. Proposals should be sent to Vivian Lanius, Vivian.lanius@ucb.com. *Chairs: Heidi Mestl (SAWP member, NoMA, NO), Patrick Schlömer (Bayer, DE)* Panelists: (*MWP member, #[alternate] SAWP member) NN (affiliation, country code), NN (affiliation, country code), NN (affiliation, country code), NN (affiliation, country code), NN (affiliation, country code), … Topic 1: NN (affiliation, country code): Title Topic 2: NN (affiliation, country code): Title … Topic 5: NN (affiliation, country code): Title Topic 6: NN (affiliation, country code): Title
12:30 – 14:00 (90 min)	Lunch break and poster session: ESIGs and EFSPI Working Groups
14:00 – 15:30 (90 min)	**Global Regulatory Strategic Priorities: Key Updates and Discussion with Health Authorities** This session provides concise updates on current regulatory strategic priorities and key developments from major global health authorities, most likely including China CDE, the EMA, FDA, and MHRA/Swissmedic, with a focus on topics most relevant to industry. The updates are followed by an interactive discussion, offering the audience an opportunity to engage directly with presenters through questions and dialogue. *Chairs: …* Talk 1: NN … Titel of the presentation Talk 2: Elina Asikanius (SAWP & MWP member, fimea, FI): Talk will focus on legislation in general Talk 3: Greg Levin (FDA, US, virtual): Titel of the presentation Talk 4: NN … Titel of the presentation Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience and the speakers.

15:30 – 16:00 (30 min)	Coffee break
16:00 – 17:30 (90 min)	**Draft EMA Guideline on Non-Inferiority and Equivalence: Key Updates and Stakeholder Perspectives** This session will summarize the key thinking behind the EMA draft guideline on non-inferiority and equivalence comparisons in clinical trials and the most important changes introduced. It will then examine and discuss selected stakeholder comments submitted during the public consultation, highlighting areas of consensus, concern, and potential impact on future practice. *Chairs: Anouk Neven (EMA, LU), Helle Lynggaard (Novo Nordisk, DK)* Talk 1: Susanne Urach (AGES, AT): Key changes in the draft guideline with potential impact on future practice and received public comments Talk 2: Tobias Mütze (Novartis, CH): Opportunities and challenges in the draft EMA non-inferiority guideline: a stakeholder perspective Q&A and discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelists: Florian Lasch (EMA, NL) and NN (affiliation, country code)
17:30 – 19:00	**Apéro & Informal Networking** – Enjoy light refreshments and drinks in a relaxed setting, and take the opportunity to continue conversations and connect with fellow participants.

Day 2: 20th August 2026, 09:00-17:30

Time	Presentation
09:00 – 10:30 (90 min)	**Development of patient relevant and sensitive endpoints – opportunities for statisticians** This session will address recent methodological developments in clinical endpoint selection and validation, with a focus on rare diseases and pediatric populations. Emphasis will be placed on the early involvement of statisticians in endpoint strategy, highlighting their role in disease-specific, patient-relevant, and sensitive outcome measure development, as well as the value of regulatory qualification pathways and qualification opinions to support robust evidence generation in areas of high unmet need. *Chairs:* *Elina Asikanius (SAWP & MWP member, fimea, FI),* *Claudia Dallinger (Boehringer Ingelheim, DE)* Talk 1: NN (affiliation, country code): How to identify relevant disease domains in a heterogeneous, multi-domain syndrome? Measuring what matters: case study from Angelmans Syndrome Talk 2: NN (affiliation, country code): Duchenne example: successful qualification replacing an old "standard" endpoint (6MWT) by a digital endpoint (stride velocity) Talk 3: NN (affiliation, country code): Regulatory perspective on endpoint development and qualification opinion (with focus on endpoint development, not qualification in general) Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelist: HTA or patient advocacy expert (affiliation, country code)
10:30 – 11:00 (30 min)	Coffee break
11:00 – 12:30 (90 min)	**From first wave to future practice: learning from early Joint Clinical Assessments procedures** During the summer, publication of the first European Joint Clinical Assessment (JCA) reports is expected. As the JCA process is new, it comes with methodological and procedural challenges for all stakeholders involved (particularly in the context of rare diseases). This session will serve to share experiences from the first JCAs including core methodological challenges, PICO selection, the appraisal of indirect treatment comparisons, and characterisation of uncertainty. Attendees will gain insights into how these issues are being interpreted within the evolving EU HTA framework from different angles. *Chairs:* … Talk 1: NN (affiliation, country code): A HTA representative involved in the EU JCA would give their views on the experiences and lessons learned from early JCAs with a focus on the implementation of the methodological guidance. Likely with a focus on addressing multiple PICOs and evidence synthesis Talk 2: Industry representative (affiliation, country code): An industry representative from a company who has completed a JCA procedure to give their view on experiences and lessons learned Talk 3: Consultancy company representative (affiliation, country code): Titel of the presentation Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelist: NN (affiliation, country code)
12:30 – 14:00 (90 min)	Lunch break

Day 2: 20th August 2026, 09:00-17:30 *<continued>*

Time	Presentation
14:00 – 15:30 (90 min)	**Aligned at Baseline? Closing the Gaps on Baseline Covariate Adjustment** Adjusting for prognostic baseline covariates is a powerful tool for improving statistical efficiency in treatment effect estimation. But are industry and regulators fully aligned on its application? This session aims to close the gaps in current practice by: • Facilitating a candid dialogue between industry experts and regulators. • Clarifying current expectations and addressing perceived inconsistencies. • Fostering a shared, unified understanding of appropriate covariate adjustment strategies. *Chairs:* *NN* Talk 1: Dominic Magirr (Novartis, CH): Educational talk (from industry) covering unconditional vs. conditional treatment effects, Clarification of how this topic is different from assessing heterogeneity of treatment effects in subgroups, Difference between stratification and covariate adjustment, "Routine use of regression models to adjust" – what purpose do these models serve? Talk 2: NN : Regulatory insights / view / questions Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelist: HTA expert (affiliation, country code)
15:30 – 16:00 (30 min)	Coffee break
16:00 – 17:30 (90 min)	**Synthetic Data in Biostatistics: Definitions, Regulatory Implications, and Practical Applications** This session examines what is meant by *synthetic data* in the context of drug development, including key definitions, methodological approaches, and intended use cases. It further discusses the scientific, regulatory, and practical consequences of using synthetic data, highlighting opportunities, limitations, and implications for decision-making across development programs. *Chairs:* *NN, Pierre Mancini (Sanofi, FR)* Talk 1: NN (affiliation, country code): Titel of the presentation Talk 2: NN (affiliation, country code): Titel of the presentation Talk 3: NN (affiliation, country code): Titel of the presentation Q&A and moderated discussion with the audience, the speakers and the panelist: NN (affiliation, country code)
17:30 – 17:40	**Closure** Vivian Lanius (UCB BioSciences GmbH, Organizing and Scientific Committee, DE)

Poster session of ESIGs and EFSPI Working Groups on Day 1 (19th August 2026, 12:30 – 14:00)

ESIG/EFSPI Working Group	**Title**	**Author(s)/*Presenter*(*s*)** *on behalf of the SIG / group
Regulatory SIG	…	Fredrik Öhrn, Christoph Gerlinger, …
Multi-Component Endpoints SIG	EFSPI/PSI Multi-Component Endpoints SIG	Mickaël De Backer, *Patrick Schlömer*, *Alex Ocampo*, NN*, and Vivian Lanius
Launch and lifecycle SIG	…	…